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23 Dec 2025

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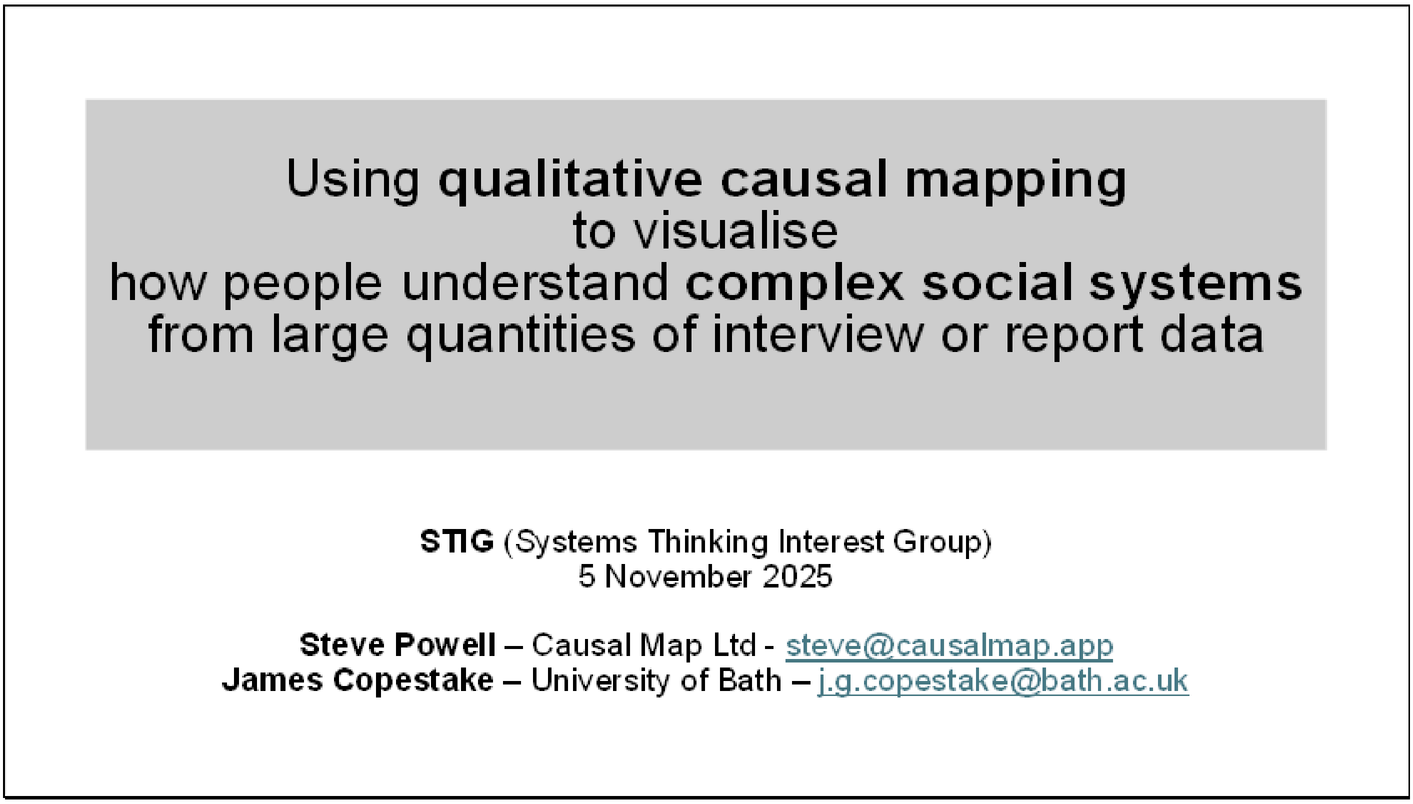


Slide 2

Outline

Context and our motivation

What is causal mapping?

Extended case study – central bankers' perceptions of the economy

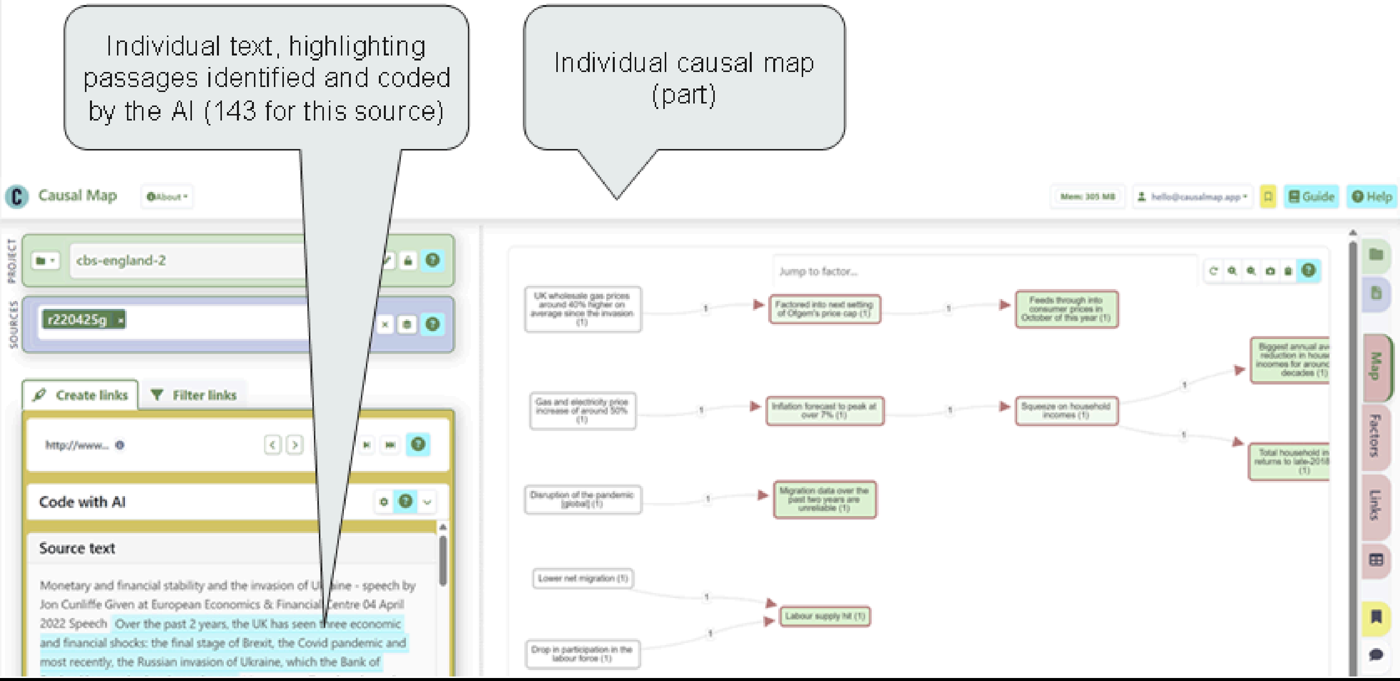
Where to go with this? Q&A

Key messages

1. A useful step to understanding complex social systems is to collect and analyse multiple stakeholders' perceptions about what is driving change
2. Causal mapping of large digitised natural language data can help us to do this better
3. It does this by enabling us to identify, combine and visualise stakeholders' mental models of the system more systematically

Slide 3

Automated coding of an individual speech



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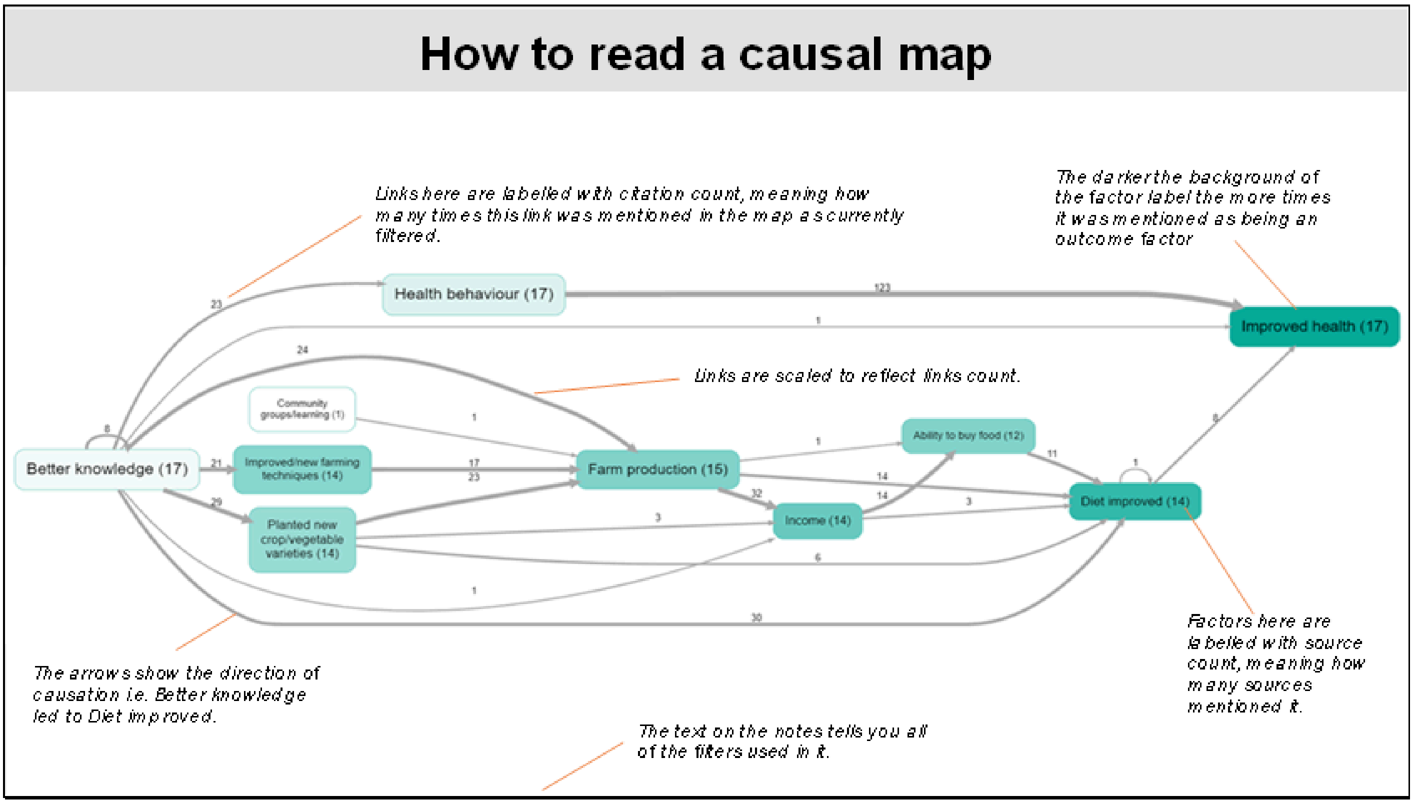

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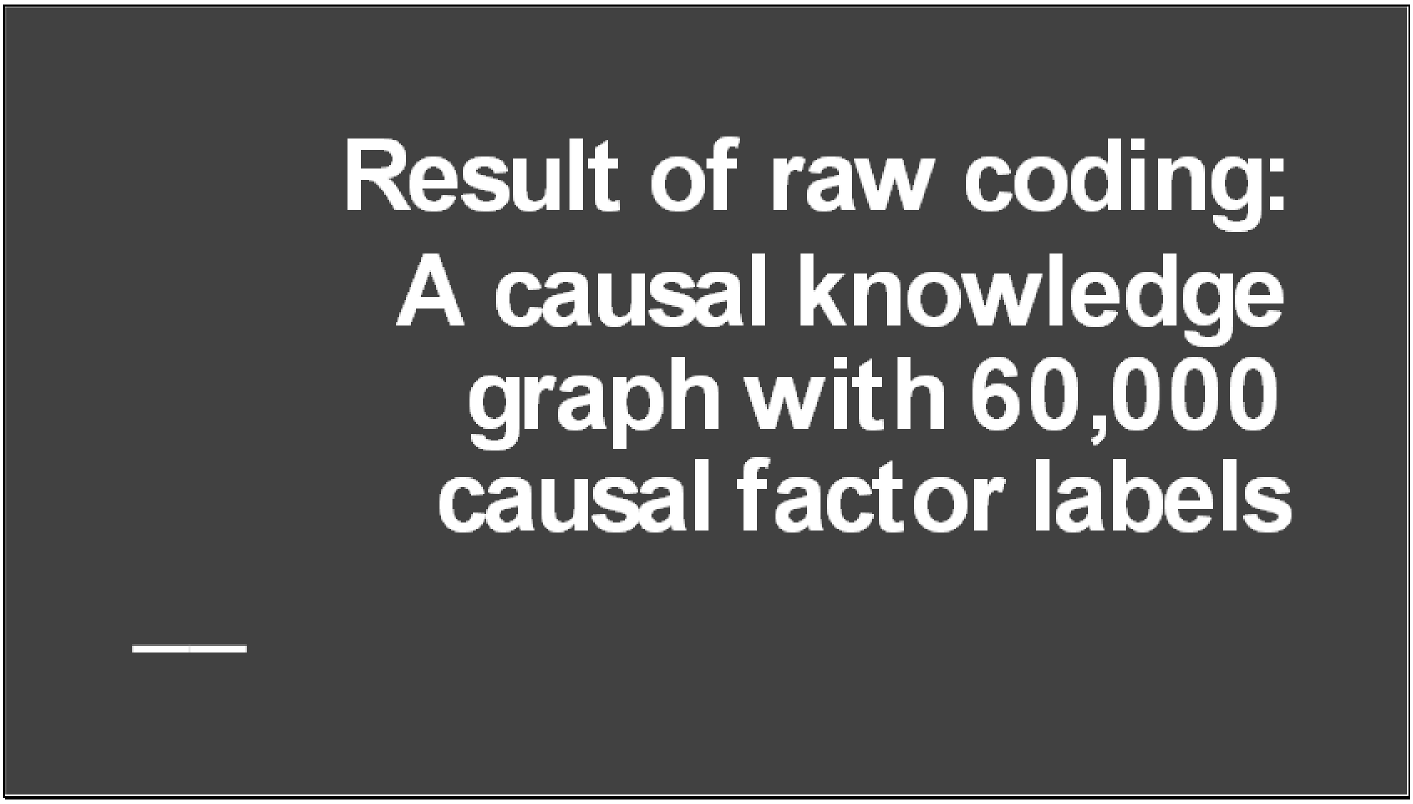

**Causal mapping identifies the factors people use in explanations: often difficult to reconcile with statistical variables

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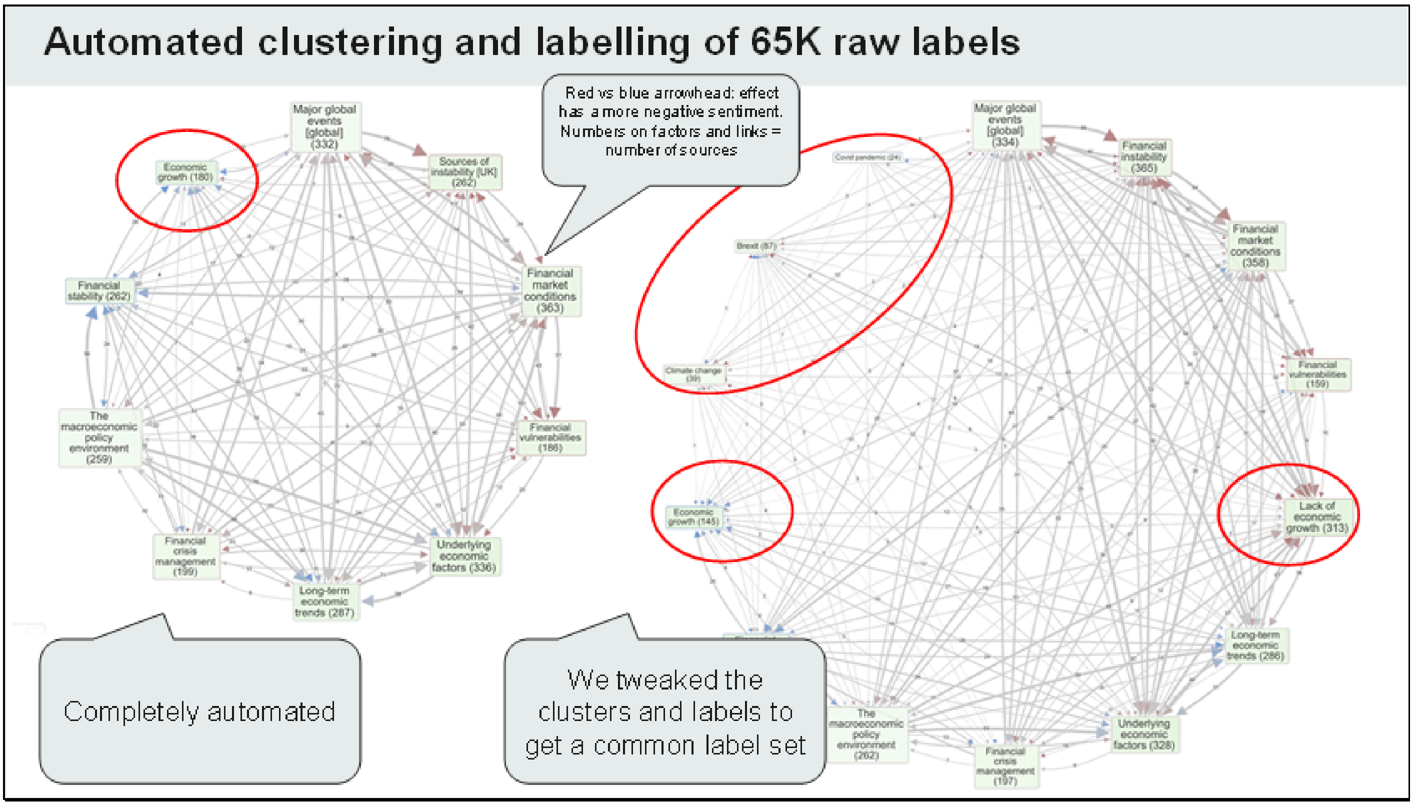

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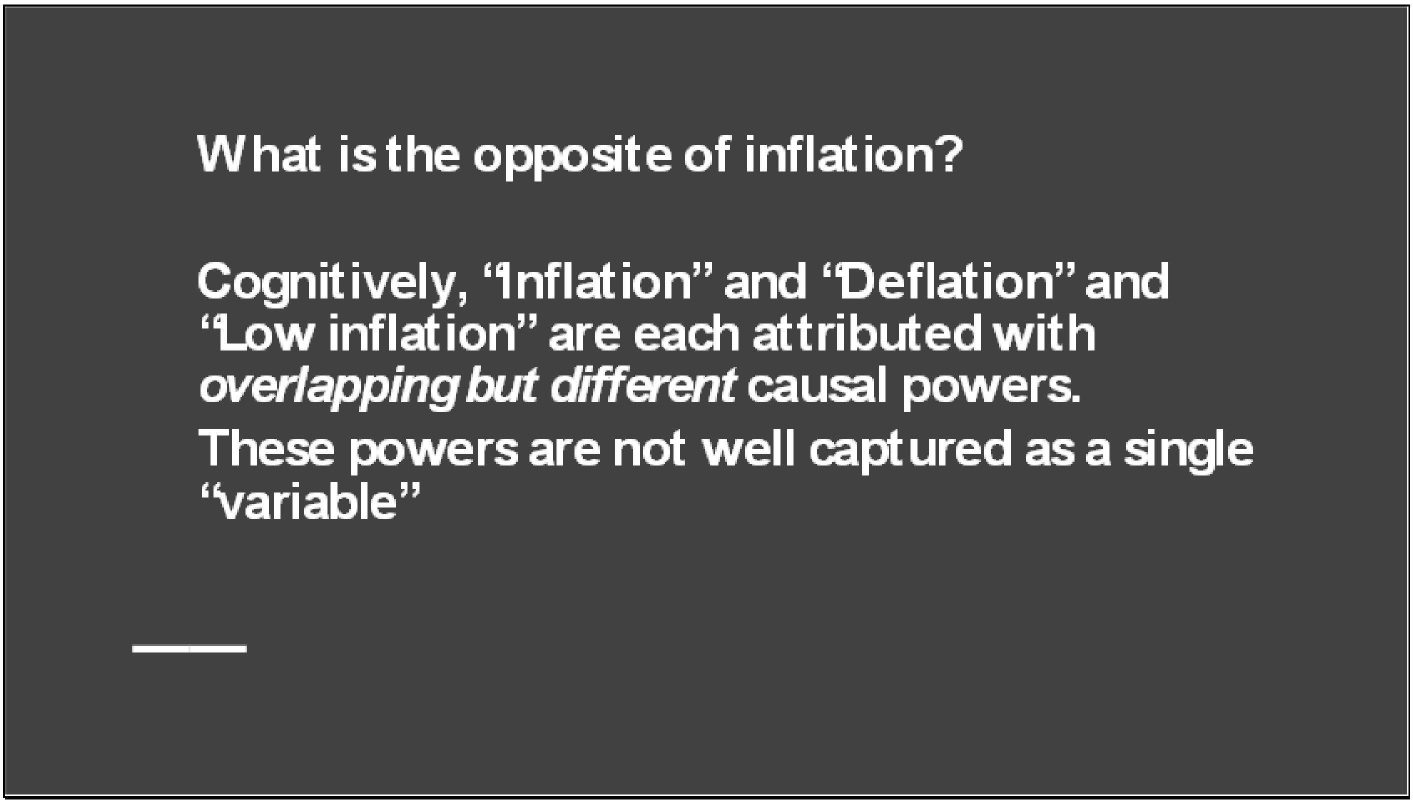

**Causal mapping identifies the factors people use in explanations: often difficult to reconcile with statistical variables

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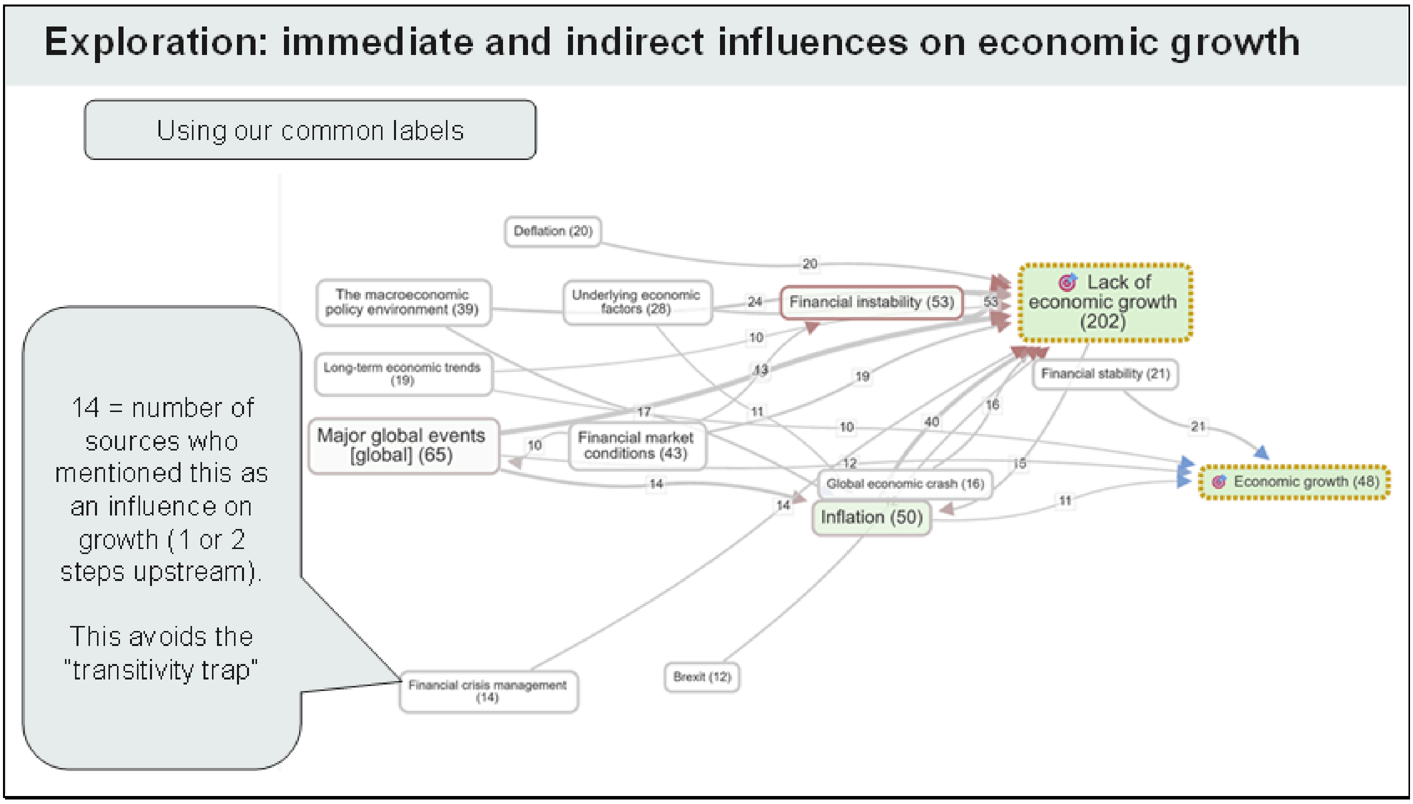

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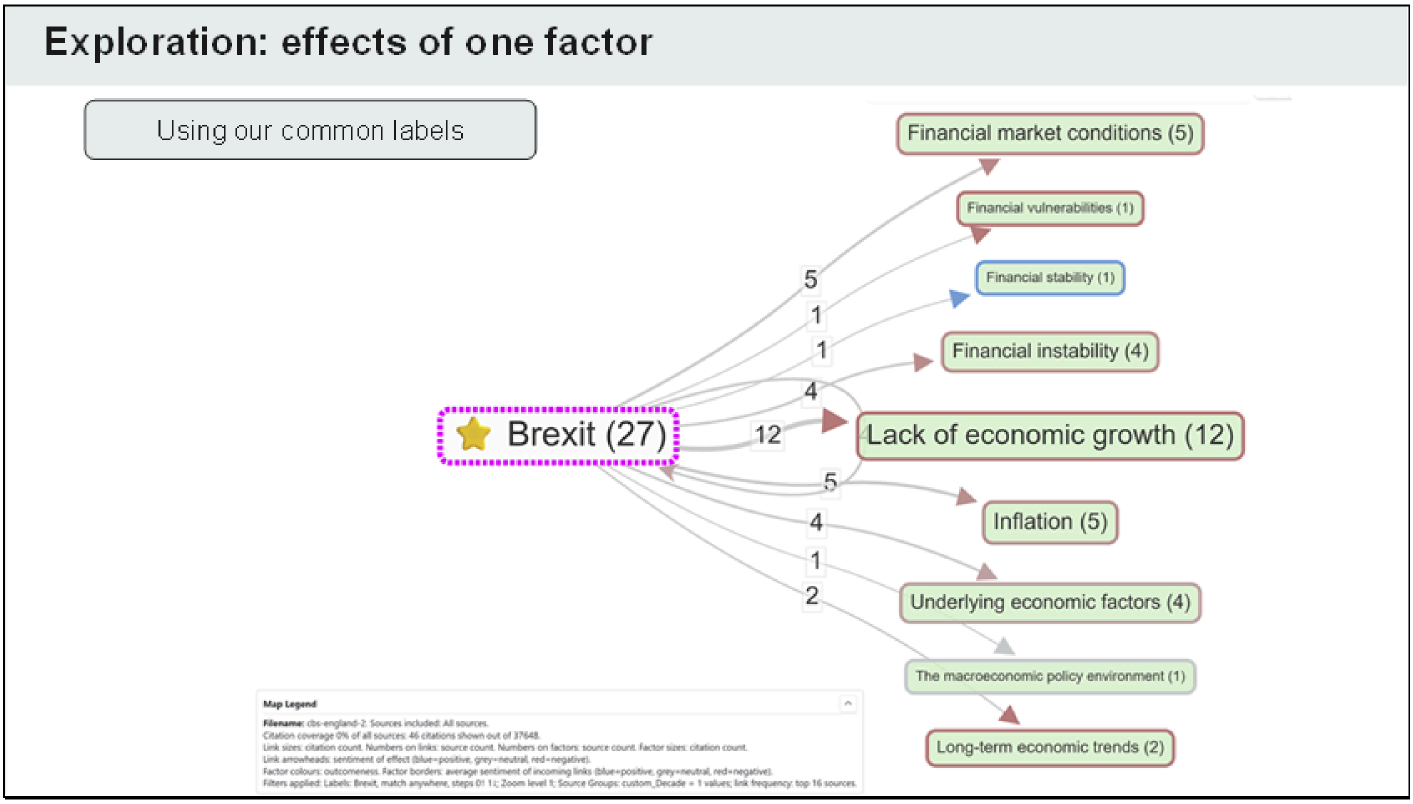

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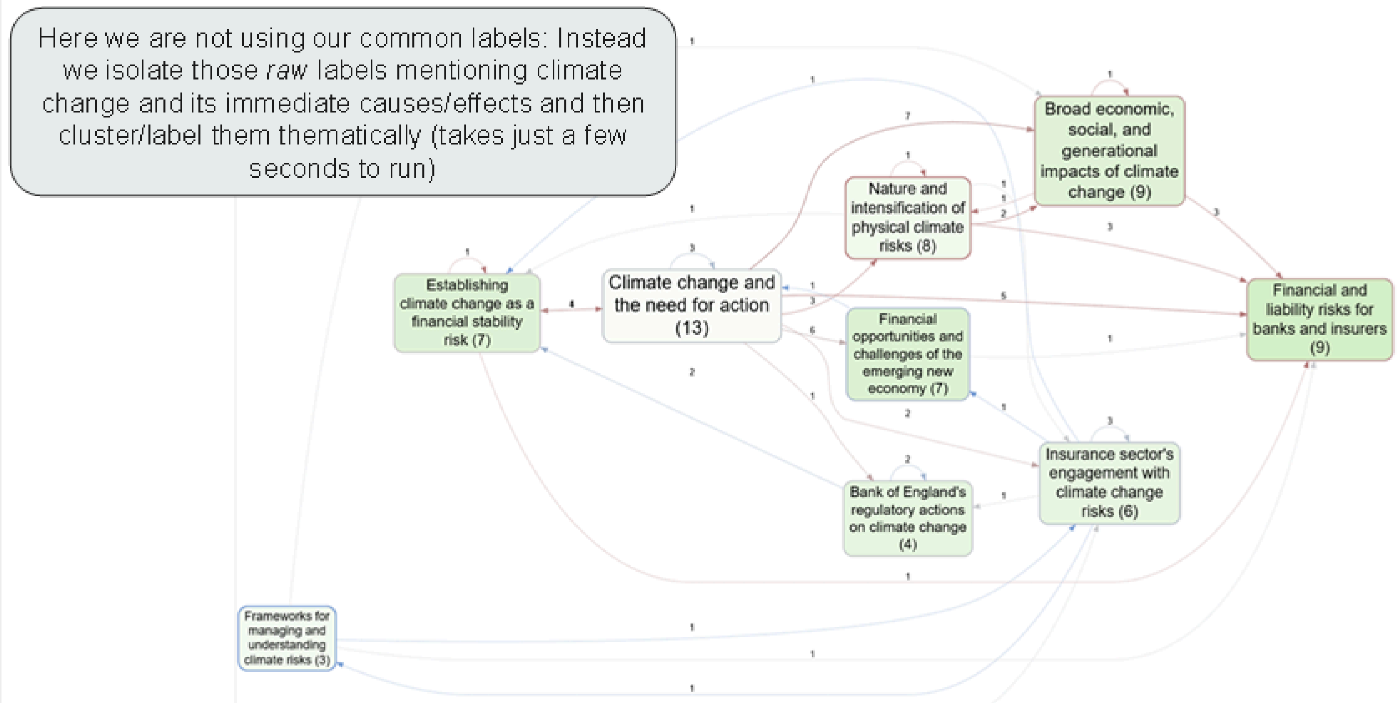
What are the narratives around climate change



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Differences by decade in explanations of lack of growth

Keeping the common labels across all 3 decades

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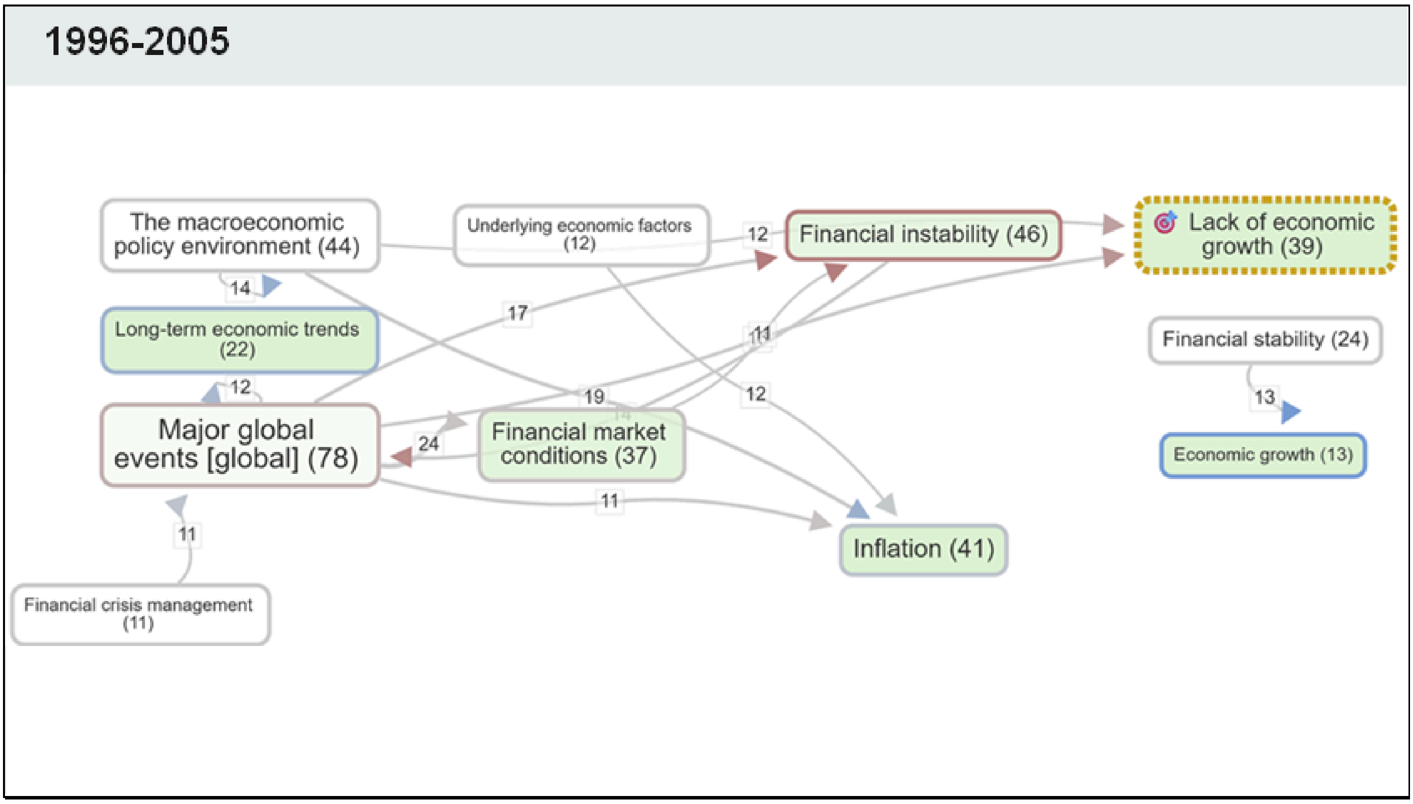

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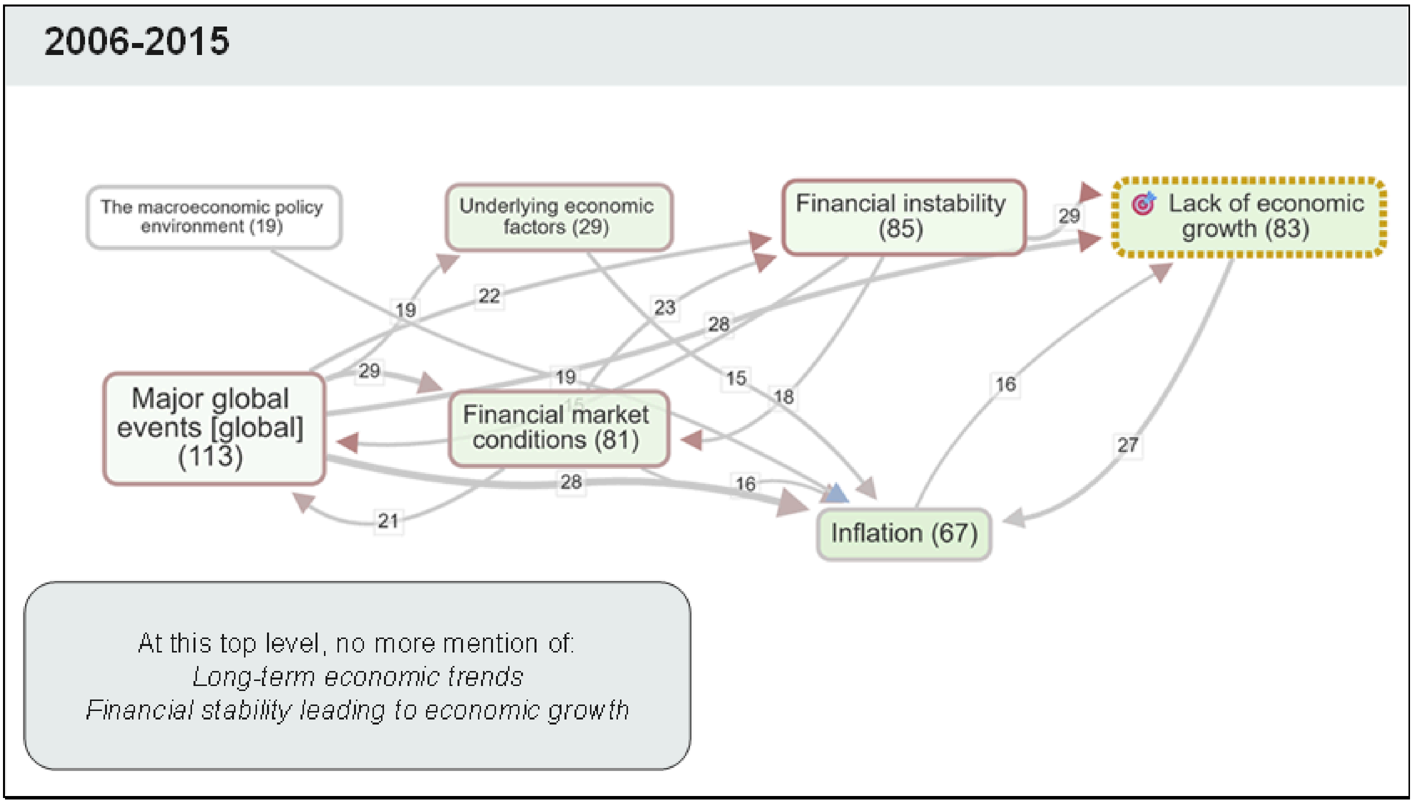

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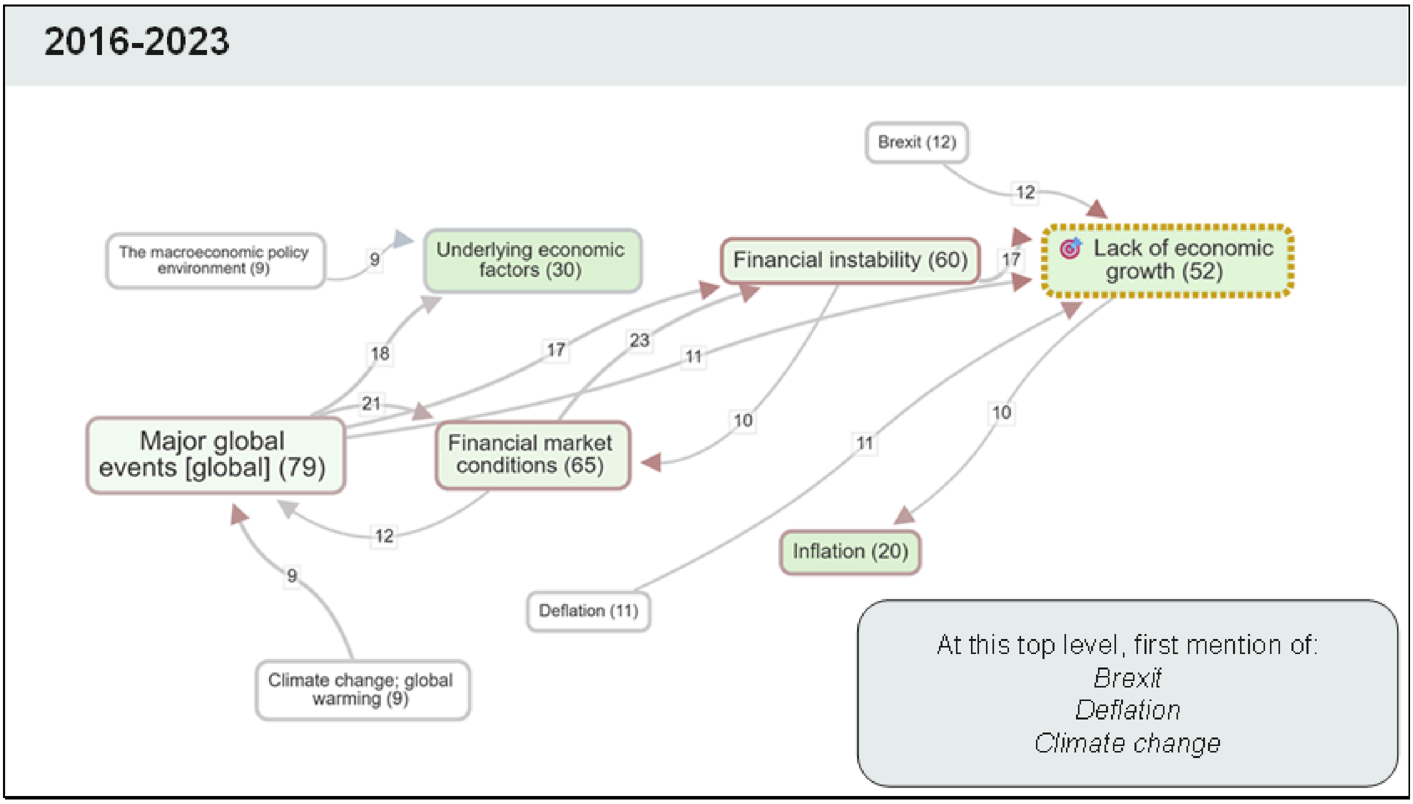

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That 3-decade comparison would have shown much bigger differences if we had used factors specific to each decade rather than the 3 decades together

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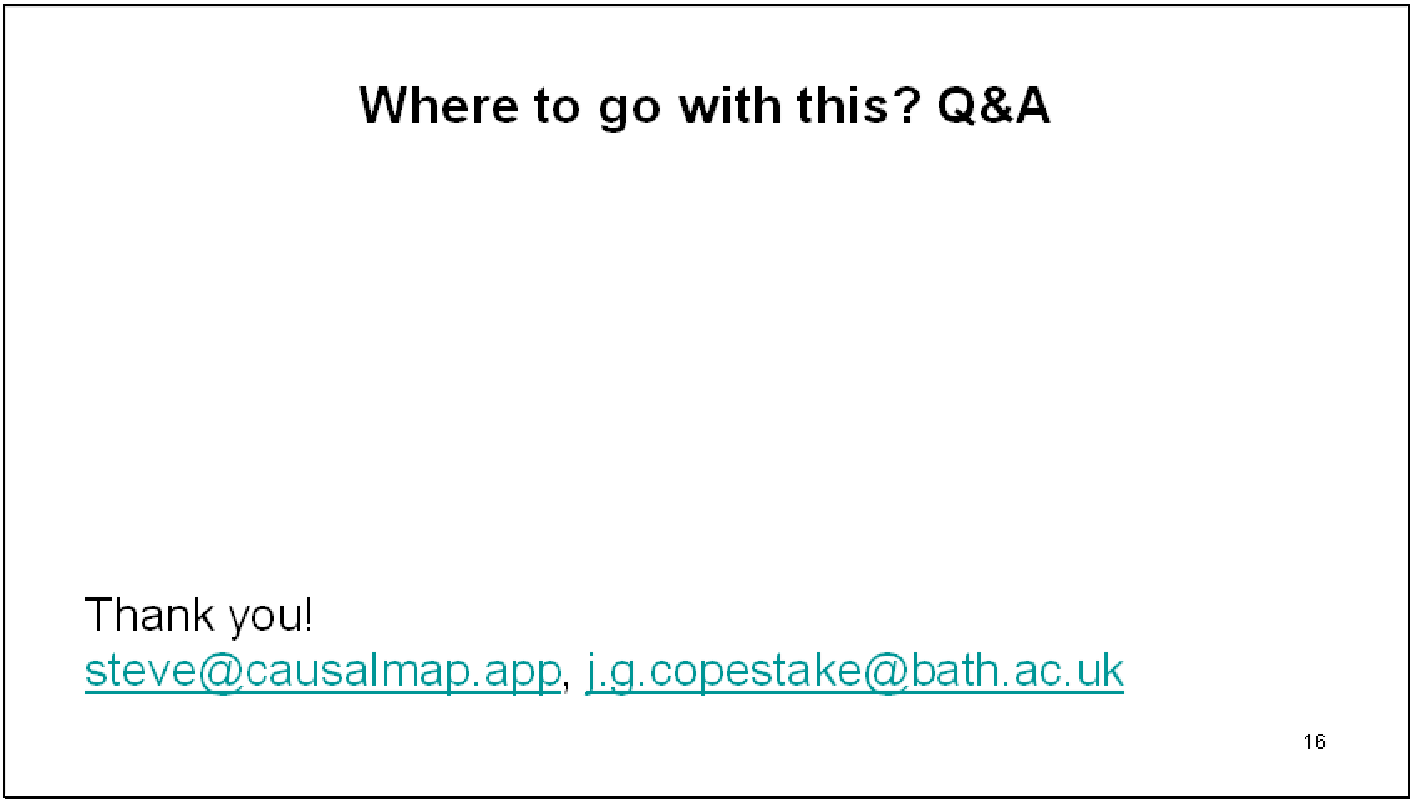

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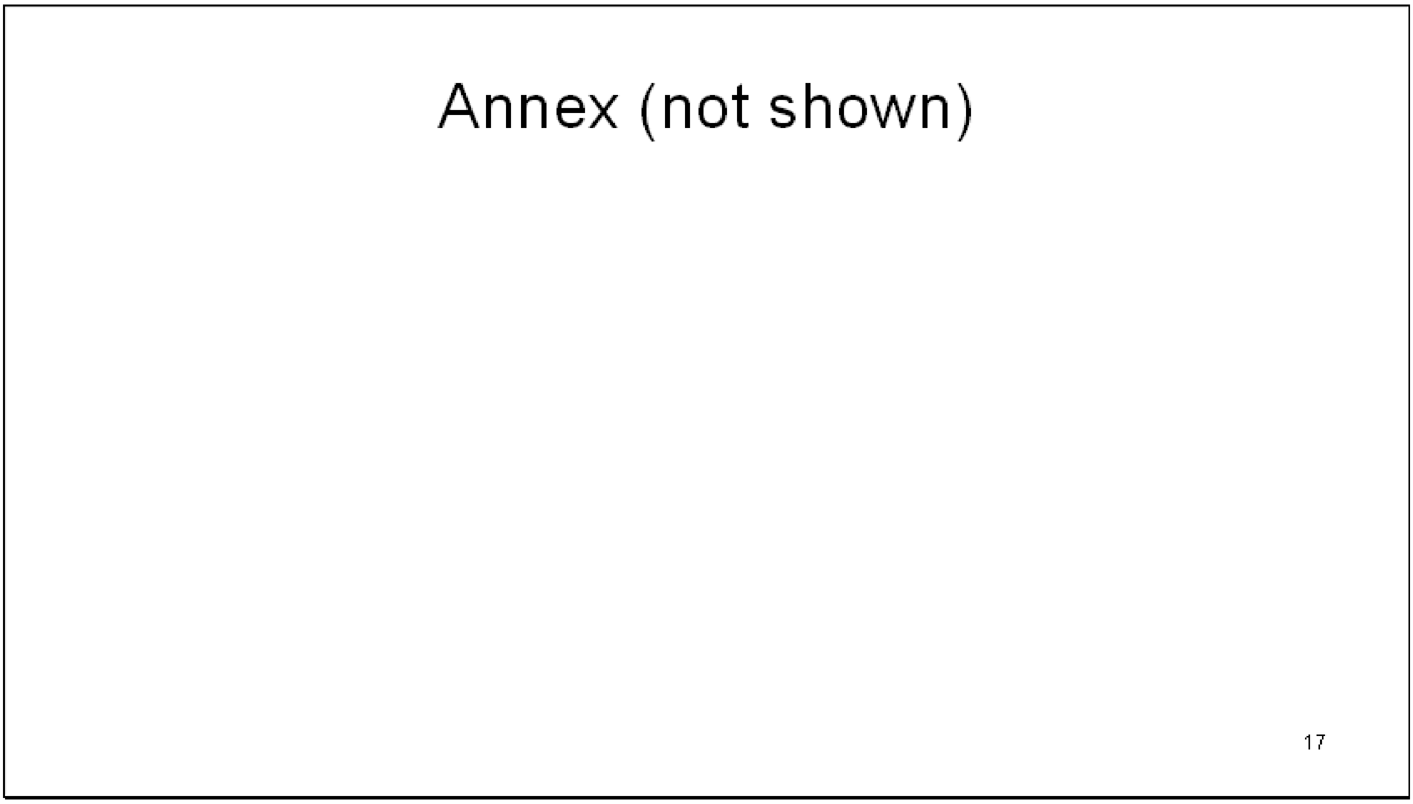

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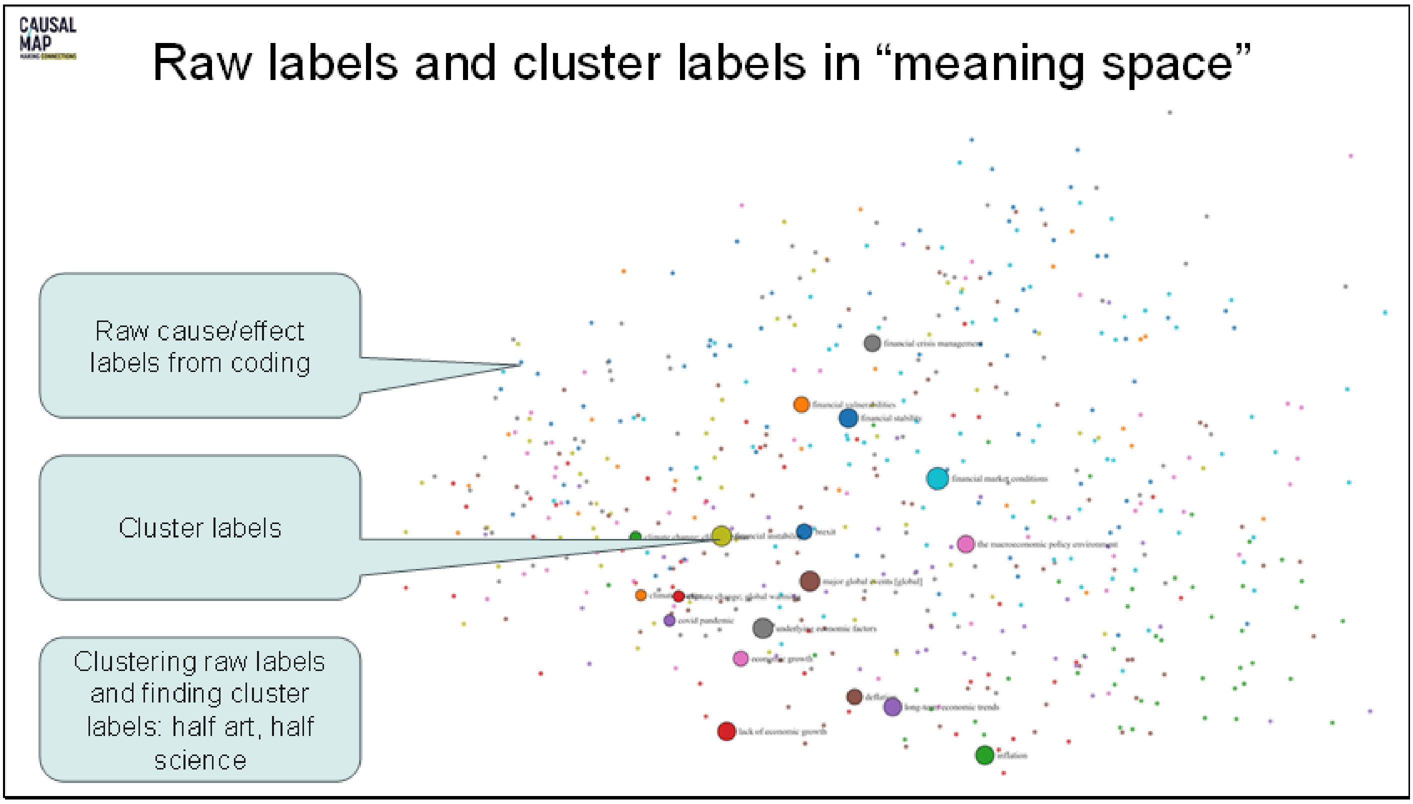
CAUSAL MAP
Raw labels and cluster labels in “meaning space”
Raw cause/effect labels from coding
Cluster labels
Clustering raw labels and finding cluster labels: half art, half science
financial crisis management
financial vulnerabilities
financial stability
financial market conditions
brexit
the macroeconomic policy environment
major global events [global]
covid pandemic
underlying economic factors
economic growth
deflation
long-term economic trends
lack of economic growth
inflation